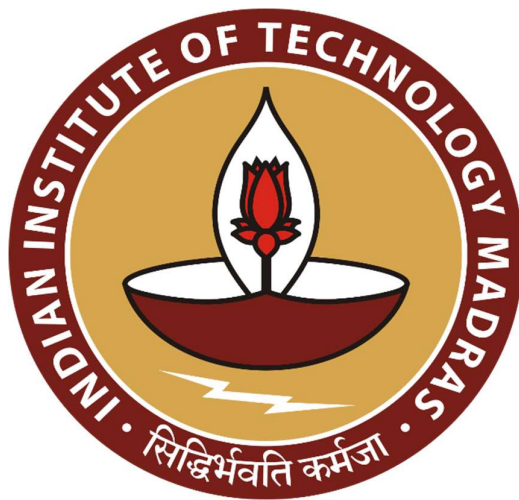


GP2 INTERIM REPORT – TEAM 13

Strategies for Professional Growth (SPG) Project | May-2026

Project Title:

Navigating Growth – A Systematic Study on Workplace Resilience & Lifelong Learning



Team 13 Members:

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|---|--------------|
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| 2. Tulika Chatterjee 23F1001999 | Page 3 |
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This interim report compiles qualitative insights from 1-on-1 discussions conducted by Team 13 with industry professionals. It analyses core themes of workplace resilience, lifelong learning, and adaptability under technological disruption, grounded in real-world career experiences and practical perspectives

I. Interviewee Details:

- a. **Name:** Gangesh
- b. **Role:** Director of Global Technical Support Organization
- c. **Experience:** 6+ Years in progressive leadership at Taboola, managing Level 1, 2, and 3 global support and working directly with R&D engineering teams.
- d. **Industry:** Advertising Technology (AdTech) / Company: Taboola
- e. **Relevance:** His role requires managing high-stakes client relationships (e.g., \$2M/year advertisers) while simultaneously leading massive AI automation initiatives. He offers a crucial leadership perspective on how to integrate cutting-edge tools while preventing team burnout and cultivating a growth mindset.

II. Key Questions & Discussion Points:

- How do you manage resilience and keep your team steady when major technical projects face sudden roadblocks?
- In a rapidly evolving landscape like AdTech, how do you practically manage continuous learning and upskilling alongside a demanding executive role?
- How do you foster a 'Growth Mindset' within your team, specifically regarding how they process failure during high-pressure troubleshooting?

III. Key Insights & Verbatim Evidence:

- **Resilience requires pivotable strategy, not just persistence.**
 - Quote: *"That was a big portion of around 30% [that] will be automated. Just because of one instance that we were not getting API sections created... that project got shifted... Instead of not moving into the API call direction, we onboarded Intercom as one of our vendors... I did not stop myself onto one avenue."* (Timestamp: 04:30-05:50)
 - Interpretation: Workplace resilience is not merely enduring pressure; it is the strategic agility to abandon blocked pathways and rapidly source alternative solutions (e.g., third-party vendors) to meet business objectives.
- **Lifelong learning is mandatory to prevent professional obsolescence.**
 - Quote: *"Whatever you learn today will not be appropriate tomorrow. So you need to always be available for all the sort of learnings... Today, I'm learning the white coding [Cursor/Codex] to ensure that my role is always relevant."* (Timestamp: 06:10-06:50)
 - Interpretation: In an era of AI disruption, resting on past expertise is a liability; proactive, self-directed upskilling (even in areas outside one's immediate job description) is essential for long-term career survival.
- **Failure is a necessary diagnostic tool for growth.**
 - Quote: *"Until you fail, you cannot learn... you are always learning from all your failures. The more you fail, the more you learn from all of those failure steps."* (Timestamp: 07:45-08:15)
 - Interpretation: A true Growth Mindset reframes failure from a marker of incompetence to a crucial data point that identifies exact areas for improvement.
- **Unlearning is just as critical as learning.**
 - Quote: *"Sometimes you need to unlearn something and relearn something because the world is too dynamic... So today, let's say you have learned something, tomorrow it might not be so relevant. So therefore, you need to unlearn this."* (Timestamp: 08:50-09:10)
 - Interpretation: Cognitive adaptability requires the humility to discard outdated methodologies and accept new paradigms, proving that rigid expertise can be a barrier in dynamic environments.

GP2 Interim Report – Tulika Chatterjee (23F1001999)

I. Interviewee Details:

- a. **Name:** Kunal Chaturvedi(Co-Founder & Tech Lead)
- b. **Role:** Co-Founder & Tech-Lead
- c. **Experience:** 7 Years across Design, Cloud Infrastructure, Medical Imaging, Hardware Interfaces, & AI.
- d. **Industry:** Medical Technology / Software / AI
- e. **Relevance:** Represents an entrepreneurial and multidisciplinary practitioner's vantage point. Offers first-hand insights into integrating Generative AI, building resilient software systems, and cultivating meta-learning capabilities in a high-stakes startup environment.

II. Key Questions & Discussion Points:

- **Career Journey:** How has your path evolved across design, cloud, hardware, and AI, and what has been the main constant?
- **Continuous Learning:** How do you systematically keep technical knowledge relevant without being overwhelmed by technological churn?
- **Agility & AI Disruption:** How have you adapted to disruptive paradigms like Generative AI and RAG in your workflow?
- **Interpersonal Skills:** Beyond technical competence, what human capabilities actually drive long-term trust and leadership?

III. Key Insights & Verbatim Evidence:

- **Continuous learning is an operational necessity, not an extracurricular activity.**
 - *Quote:* "Learning is no longer just preparation for work, it has become part of work itself." (*Timestamp: 4:00-4:06*)
 - *Interpretation:* In fast-moving technology domains, professional learning must be seamlessly integrated into daily routines and active experimentation, rather than treated as a periodic event.
- **Failures are diagnostic tools that build operational resilience.**
 - *Quote:* "Failures rarely damage careers, refusing to learn from them does... Confidence comes from surviving mistakes, not avoiding them." (*Timestamp: 6:04-6:12 and 9:40-9:46*)
 - *Interpretation:* This illustrates a Growth Mindset where early production failures are viewed as valuable learning milestones that refine judgment through iterative feedback, rather than as evidence of inadequacy.
- **Static domain mastery is less valuable than technological adaptability.**
 - *Quote:* "The biggest constant throughout my journey has been change itself... Adaptability is becoming more valuable than expertise." (*Timestamp: 2:40-2:46 and 8:15-8:21*)
 - *Interpretation:* As technology shifts (e.g., GenAI, AI Agents), static expertise quickly depreciates; professionals must view disruptions as productivity multipliers rather than threats.
- **Long-term career progression relies heavily on emotional intelligence.**
 - *Quote:* "People rarely promote someone because they know Python, but they promote them because they trust you." (*Timestamp: 10:56-11:07*)
 - *Interpretation:* While technical skills (like coding) grant initial career entry, leadership and advancement are ultimately earned through communication, interpersonal intelligence, and building reliable trust.

GP2 Interim Report – Gaurav Tomar (23f1000805)

I. Interviewee Details:

- a. **Name:** Monu Singh
- b. **Role:** Executive (XFE)
- c. **Experience:** 6 Years in customer acquisition, field sales, and team operations.
- d. **Industry:** Telecommunications (Broadband & Wi-Fi Services at Bharti Airtel)
- e. **Relevance:** As a frontline executive in a highly dynamic and customer-oriented industry, he provides a grounded perspective on building resilience through daily customer friction, the immediate impact of digital automation on sales roles, and the necessity of peer learning.

II. Key Questions & Discussion Points:

- How do you develop and maintain resilience when facing direct, daily performance pressures and customer rejections?
- In a role heavily reliant on interpersonal communication, what does lifelong learning look like practically?
- How are AI and digital automation impacting traditional customer-facing sales roles?
- What specific habits or support systems are essential for long-term career survival?

III. Key Insights & Verbatim Evidence:

- **Workplace resilience is forged through peer observation and early failure.**
 - *Quote:* "There was a phase in my career when I was struggling a lot... Gradually, I learned from my teammates... What I couldn't achieve in an entire month back then, I can do in a single day now." (*Timestamps: 01:37-02:05 and 06:25-07:02*)
 - *Interpretation:* Resilience is not an inherent trait but an acquired skill; early performance failures serve as critical catalysts for growth when met with a mindset oriented toward peer learning and adaptation.
- **Continuous learning relies heavily on active customer interaction.**
 - *Quote:* "Learning should never stop... Face-to-face conversation leaves a different kind of impact on the customer." (*Timestamps: 04:13-04:39 and 04:54-05:23*)
 - *Interpretation:* In sales and service domains, lifelong learning is driven less by formal training and more by active, daily engagement with customers, which continuously refines communication and trust-building skills.
- **AI and automation are double-edged swords for frontline roles.**
 - *Quote:* "In a way, AI poses a threat to our jobs as well." (*Timestamp: 09:28-10:02*)
 - *Interpretation:* While digital platforms (like automated online bookings) increase operational efficiency, they simultaneously threaten traditional roles, highlighting the urgent need for professionals to continuously reskill to stay relevant.
- **Career longevity depends on disciplined habits and supportive leadership.**
 - *Quote:* "My manager had a very big role in my career... We made it a habit that we must work well on these days [weekends]." (*Timestamps: 10:11-11:05 and 11:36-12:25*)
 - *Interpretation:* Sustained professional growth is a combination of individual discipline (e.g., maximizing high-traffic days) and an organizational environment that provides critical mentorship during difficult career phases.

GP2 Interim Report – Anjali Gupta (21F2000306)

I. Interviewee Details:

- a. **Name:** Krithika Sadanand
- b. **Role:** Co-Founder & Tech-Lead
- c. **Experience:** Commercial Manager
- d. **Industry:** Construction
- e. **Relevance:** Given her decade of experience in an industry that traditionally relies on heavy operational processes, her transition into a strategic role offers a grounded perspective on how continuous learning and AI adoption are practically applied outside of the typical IT sector.

II. Key Questions & Discussion Points:

- How has your specific role evolved over the years due to increasing project complexity?
- What practical strategies do you use to stay relevant and adaptable in a rapidly changing workplace?
- What tangible role does AI currently play in your daily workflow and overall productivity?
- From a leadership perspective, what core habits help professionals remain resilient under pressure?

III. Key Insights & Verbatim Evidence:

- Modern roles require strategic expansion beyond technical expertise.
 - *Quote:* "Initially, the focus was mainly on contract administration and cost control. Now, a significant part of my responsibility is influencing projects before they are even won." (*Question at 0:00, Quote at 0:20-0:32*)
 - *Interpretation:* Workplace adaptability requires professionals to move beyond rigid job descriptions; resilience is tied to expanding one's scope to influence earlier stages of business strategy.
- Continuous learning is driven by hands-on friction, not just formal education.
 - *Quote:* "Hands-on experience teaches you much better than what we've learned in university. Every day is a new challenge... You need to be one person better today than you were yesterday." (*Question at 3:35, Quotes at 3:55-04:08 and 04:47-04:52*)
 - *Interpretation:* True lifelong learning is an active, daily discipline built through real-world problem solving, reinforcing the idea that theoretical knowledge must be constantly stress-tested against operational reality.
- AI serves as an operational accelerator, not a strategic replacement.
 - *Quote:* "Something that would have taken me three to four days... now it's taking me just a couple of hours. I believe that AI has really helped us to adapt." (*Question at 2:40, Quotes at 02:58-03:05 and 03:28-03:31*)
 - *Interpretation:* By viewing AI as a productivity enabler, professionals can cognitively offload repetitive administrative tasks and redirect their mental energy toward complex, high-stakes decision making.
- Resilience is a systematic approach to problem-solving.
 - *Quote:* "Break them down into smaller, manageable action points rather than trying to solve everything at once." (*Question at 5:30, Quote at 05:47-05:55*)
 - *Interpretation:* Psychological resilience in the workplace is largely a matter of process; breaking down overwhelming disruptions into tactical steps prevents burnout and maintains team momentum.

GP2 Interim Report – Santhanu S (23f2004832)

I. Interviewee Details:

- a. **Name:** Chithraj
- b. **Role:** Full Stack Developer
- c. **Experience:** 3+ Years
- d. **Industry:** AI Automation (Company: Slate)
- e. **Relevance:** As a developer working directly within the AI automation space, he offers a front-line perspective on how professionals in highly disruptive fields manage continuous learning, regulate emotional responses to change, and unlearn outdated leadership paradigms.

II. Key Questions & Discussion Points:

- How do you balance formal credentials with informal, experiential learning?
- Have you ever had to unlearn a deeply ingrained mindset to keep pace with industry changes?
- How do you regulate your emotional and operational response to sudden workplace restructuring?
- Can you share a specific instance where a willingness to upskill directly prevented career redundancy?

III. Key Insights & Verbatim Evidence:\

➤ **Experiential learning drives competence; formal learning drives validation.**

- *Quote:* "Courses are good when I need to prove I know something. But real learning, the stuff that actually sticks, that's mostly happened on the job." (*Timestamp: 1:20-2:13*)
- *Interpretation:* Lifelong learning requires a dual approach: theoretical credentials are used strategically for external validation (like promotions), while true competence is built through the friction of daily operational mistakes.

➤ **Adapting to modern work requires the 'unlearning' of rigid hierarchies.**

- *Quote:* "Everything was very hierarchy-based... I had to unlearn that completely and become more open, more like a facilitator than a boss." (*Timestamp: 3:21-4:01*)
- *Interpretation:* Adaptability is not just about acquiring new technical skills; it fundamentally requires the psychological flexibility to abandon outdated, rigid leadership models in favor of collaborative facilitation.

➤ **Resilience is an active practice of emotional regulation and deliberate pause.**

- *Quote:* "I give it a day, maybe two, just to sit with it. Then I ask myself, what does this actually mean for my day-to-day." (*Timestamp: 4:06-5:04*)
- *Interpretation:* Workplace resilience is demonstrated through emotional control; creating deliberate space between an initial panic reaction and a strategic response prevents burnout during periods of high disruption.

➤ **Proactive upskilling is the ultimate defense against automation.**

- *Quote:* "I picked up a course on process automation myself, nights and weekends. That's literally what got me promoted." (*Timestamp: 5:58-6:50*)
- *Interpretation:* When faced with the threat of redundancy, individuals with a Growth Mindset convert anxiety into action through self-directed learning, turning a potential career setback into an advantage.